Minutes: NZRA Committee meeting 13 February 2012

Venue: 6 Harrods Court, Christchurch

Attendees: Pete Squires, Bill Kennedy, Grant Hunter, Douglas Woods, Emma de Lacey, Dave Laurie (Nick Collins available as needed by telephone)
Apologies: Phil Bones, Trevor Merrifield

Matters arising from previous meeting (21 November 2011)

Gear storage: Most gear held by the association in Canterbury has found its way to new/temporary storage in the garage of Douglas Woods. This gear is loaned to bona-fide event organisers anywhere, usually at nil cost.

Local matters (Canterbury)

Heights of Winter, 30 June: Dave Laurie reports he has the main farmer on board, and continues to try to meet two neighbours (aiming for next week or second week March). We may need additional properties beyond the three. Main organisers to be Dave and Pete (Dave as the contact person). Grant can cover community liaison if asked once venue is confirmed. Further discussion about getting new people engaged in event organising, including approaching regular event participants (Bill/Pete may follow up).

City 'restart event': interested in organising a CHCH city event, aiming for next summer? (Tim, Douglas, Pete)

National matters

Phil Bones resigned from committee membership, citing his new position as Head of Department of Electrical & Computer Engineering, UofC. We thanked Phil for his contributions to rogaining and wish him all the best. Phil expects to continue to participate in events and lend a hand with course planning from time to time, and continue to encourage others into the sport.

World Champs

- **WRC2012 entries update:** All NZers wishing to participate in this event are able to do so. 35 have had entries confirmed and a total of 47 have entered and await finalising entry fee payments etc.
- **WRC entry criteria:** International debate about an ultra-vet category and shifting the junior grade to U23 continues.
- **Australasian Championships:** An opportunity may be opening up for the Aus/NZ WRC qualifying events to be rebranded the 'Australasian Championships', with NZ hosting every fifth one. Richard Robinson (ARA) is thinking " ... either the Australian or NZ Champs (I would suggest NZ Champs every fifth year) be designated the Australasian Champs and that the Australasian Champs be the nominated WRC qualifying event. That means that there would be no separate NZ or Australian Champs in the years that they are also designated the Australasian Champs." He has not discussed this with his executive but aims to do so before their AGM in May.

We support the above two initiatives for change, but prefer to keep a watching brief on thinking and developments beyond our shores at this stage.

2012 National (NZ) Champs, 24/25 November update: (Bob Cunninghame)

Planning/setting is underway. Still to formalise access with the landowners. Grant to supply safety plan template and copy of Public Liability insurance policy to assist with this.

Mostly open farmland and tussock country with intricate streams and drainage patterns, with some woodlots. The base will be a woolshed, with an adjacent camping area. Catering by the local school parents' committee. A local committee has formed for general organisation. Gear will later need to be sent down from Christchurch. Entries and finances handled through the usual NZRA sources and website (Bill and Trevor). A draft budget to be sent to NZRA committee shortly. We encourage Bob to include a shorter event, say 8 hours. Do we need to provide transport (ex-CHCH and/or ex-Dunedin)?

National rogaine series:

Plans are progressing, coordinated and led by Nick Collins and based on the thinking at a national committee meeting in Wellington last November. The meeting concurred on several points, though further discussion is bound to be needed on some of them:

- In year 1, work with two events in each of the N and S Islands
- the yearly event cycle is the calendar year, since rogaining is not really a seasonal sport (Noted Nick suggests a summer cycle - may need further discussion). This means Year 1 would be 2013 calendar year (not the 2012/13 summer suggest by NC).
- Results relate to individuals, as team membership is often in states of flux.
- All events to be NZRA rules compliant and use electronic scoring
- Need a small organising committee as many details need to be worked through, e.g. how to select qualifying events, setting up an event management database.
- Recommend an initial core group to comprise Nick Collins (Taranaki), Mondo Kopua (Marlborough) and Douglas Woods (Canterbury). This group could be extended. DW thinks he can arrange a series database. Grant to check their availability/willingness.
- The core group to make recommendations on the series to NZRA for approval.

A truly national association:

NZRA continues to struggle with how to more fully deal with the 'national scale'. To this end, in the short term we will place emphasis on getting the national series established. This may stimulate a stronger national outlook and engagement on organisation of rogaining (and hence national organisational structure). It is a somewhat delicate balance. Many national-scale issues are around elite and higher-level competition. While this reflects healthy, appropriate and timely growth in the rogaining outlook in New Zealand, we recognise a risk that it could become a resource demanding distraction from NZRA's primary role (and rules) of supporting the growth and delivery of rogaining for 'rank and file' New Zealanders (i.e., 'good events for all' ahead of 'elite competition'.

Regional representatives in NZRA:

As a holding position in terms of the above, Grant to write to each regional rep before the AGM to confirm they are willing and engaged to continue to offer a regional presence for the association and for local rogainers.

Navlight sponsorship:

Agreed to provide free use of Navlight scoring devices to the annual Taranaki Secondary School Rogaine Champs again this year, as well as for junior individuals entering the proposed

national rogaine series. (Noted that this is a concession willingly made by NZRA, and that NZRA will continue to pay the regular royalty to the Navlight developer on these sponsored entries.)

Communicating with membership:

We are aware that our interaction with membership is largely limited to the nuts and bolts of events, plus the information on the association website and in our newsletters. We do not have a mechanism for behind-the-scenes interaction. We agreed to trial posting minutes of committee meetings on the website, and possibly summaries of key points in newsletters. This may help to get wider awareness and engagement on matters affecting the future of rogaining.

Links with NZOF, especially with regard to NZ national champs:

Grant to arrange a meeting with NZOF to discuss how we proceed organising the annual NZ Champs. Current practice is to alternate NZRA/NZOF annually, but NZOF was unable to engage in the current year.

AGM: Monday, 27th February, Christchurch.

Meeting ended
Minutes compiled GGH 17/2/12